

ACCEPT RESPONSIBILITY FOR ILLEGAL BEHAVIOR

GOALS OF THE EXERCISE

1. Describe the behavior that led to current legal conflicts.
2. Accept responsibility for the steps leading to the illegal behavior, as well as the behavior itself.
3. Acknowledge the harm that the illegal behavior caused to others.

ADDITIONAL PROBLEMS FOR WHICH THIS EXERCISE MAY BE MOST USEFUL

- Anger Management
- Antisocial Behavior
- Impulse Control Disorder

SUGGESTIONS FOR PROCESSING THIS EXERCISE WITH THE CLIENT

Be alert to the client's attempts to project blame onto others for his/her illegal behavior. Try to highlight the series of decisions that were made that eventually led to the illegal activity. Reinforce acceptance of full responsibility for decisions and actions.

ACCEPT RESPONSIBILITY FOR ILLEGAL BEHAVIOR

When a change in behavior pattern is necessary, the first step to be taken is to accept responsibility for the actions taken previously. Therefore, this assignment is directed toward having you honestly and completely acknowledge what you did that was illegal, who was hurt by your behavior, and what decisions led to this choice of activity on your part.

1. Describe in detail the illegal behavior that you engaged in.

2. List who was harmed by your behavior and how they were affected.

Who

Harmful Effect

3. Describe the series of steps that led to your illegal action (when did you think of doing it, who did you discuss it with, what preparations did you make before initiating the action, etc).

4. Describe how you feel about having acted illegally.

5. Why is it important for you to take full responsibility for your illegal behavior without blaming others or excusing yourself?
